



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

evaṃ sa* dharmam* vi+vidham* cakāra |
sadbhir* nipātaṃ* śrutitaś* ca siddham |
dṛṣṭvā katham* putra+mukham* suto* me |
vanam* na yāyād* iti nāthamānaḥ ||2.54|*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 2, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verse speaks of King Śuddhodana's profound efforts to secure Siddhartha's future within the palace walls, desperately trying to prevent him from renouncing worldly life. He diligently created an environment steeped in righteousness and virtue, meticulously crafting experiences designed to bind Siddhartha to the kingdom. The "dharma" he cultivated wasn't necessarily the ultimate truth Siddhartha would later discover, but rather a carefully curated version intended to showcase the joys and stability of royal life.

King Śuddhodana listened to wise advisors and drew upon scripture, seeking every possible means to ensure his son remained content and attached to his princely duties. He believed that if Siddhartha witnessed the joy of fatherhood, holding his own child, the allure of the world would be too strong to resist. The king's deep love manifested as a protective, albeit ultimately futile, attempt to shield Siddhartha from the realities of suffering and impermanence. He was essentially trying to control Siddhartha's destiny, driven by fear of loss and a desire for worldly continuity.

This parental anxiety resonates deeply even today. How often do you, in your own life, try to orchestrate the future of your loved ones, particularly your children? Do you subtly (or not so subtly) steer them towards paths you deem safe and successful, fearing the unknown possibilities that lie beyond? This verse serves as a potent reminder that while our intentions may be rooted in love, clinging to control ultimately hinders the unfolding of another's unique dharma. Just as Siddhartha's path lay beyond the gilded cage of the palace, the truest potential of those we love may lie in embracing their individual journeys, even if those journeys lead them away from our own expectations. The king's actions, though born of love, highlight the limitations of worldly strategies in the face of spiritual calling.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What are the ways you might be inadvertently hindering the spiritual growth of your loved ones by trying to control their life choices, and how can you release that need for control with compassion?